

Brain-Based Mental Health Community

Cognitive Behavioral Therapy (CBT) Feedback

NAME

DATE

Review the live website before providing feedback:

<https://tcfasd.github.io/Brain-Based-Mental-Health-/handout-therapy-guide.html>

Ages 7+ | Brain-Based Fit: Limited Without Modification

What It Asks the Brain to Do:

CBT asks the brain to notice its own thoughts, evaluate whether those thoughts are accurate, and replace unhelpful thoughts with more helpful ones. It teaches the connection between thoughts, feelings, and behavior — and uses the thinking brain (prefrontal cortex) to regulate emotions. This is a "top-down" approach: it starts with thinking and works down to feelings and behavior.

Caregiver Involvement:

Varies. Traditional CBT is often individual — the child or teen meets alone with the therapist. Some programs include parent sessions, but caregiver involvement is not built into the standard model.

How to Know If It Might Be a Good Fit:

- Your child can identify and talk about their thoughts and feelings
- Your child can think abstractly (understanding cause and effect, "if/then" reasoning)
- Anxiety, depression, or distorted thinking is the primary concern
- Your child can remember and apply skills learned in session to real life

Brain-Based Consideration

:CBT relies on self-monitoring, abstract reasoning, working memory, and the ability to generalize skills to new situations — these are often the exact areas where brain-based differences create challenges. Children may appear to "learn" CBT skills in session but be unable to apply them in real life. If your child isn't responding to CBT, the first question should be "Can their brain do what this therapy is asking?" — not "Are they not trying hard enough?"

1. Is what is written accurate?

Yes

No

Yes

2. Is there additional information that you think caregivers should know about Cognitive Behavioral Therapy (CBT)?

Thank you for your feedback!